8.11 Addison's Disease and Adrenal Crisis

Assessment	Nursing Diagnosis	Plan / Expected Outcome	Nursing Interventions	Evaluation
Subjective • "I feel weak and dizzy, and vomit." **Objective** • BP 80/50 mmHg • Na^+ 128 mmol/L, K^+ 5.8 mmol/L • Skin darker than usual	**ACTUAL** **Deficient fluid volume** related to aldosterone and cortisol deficiency as evidenced by hypotension and hyponatremia.	BP stable within 6 hours.	• Give IV hydrocortisone straight away, as prescribed. • Give IV saline and dextrose as ordered. • Follow vital signs, glucose and electrolytes.	BP stable: **goal met**.
Subjective • "Why must I double my tablets when sick?" **Objective** • Just diagnosed • Cannot explain the sick-day rules	**ACTUAL** **Deficient knowledge** related to steroid replacement as evidenced by questions.	Can explain the sick-day rules.	• Teach him never to stop his steroids. • Teach him to raise the dose on sick days as instructed. • He should carry a steroid card and an emergency injection.	Explains the rules: **goal met**.
Subjective • *No specific complaint* **Objective** • Cortisol deficiency • Glucose 62 mg/dL on arrival	**RISK** **Risk for unstable blood glucose level** as evidenced by risk factors: cortisol deficiency.	Blood glucose stays within the normal range.	• Check glucose. • Give dextrose as ordered. • Give hydrocortisone on time.	Normal: **goal met**.